

Justification File

The Internal: Tiny Doctor Big Dreams

1. Overall design goals stayed the same

Despite mechanical refinements, the core idea remained the same:

- A Vein-like tunnel obstacle course
- Boss fights with phases and varied behaviour
- Endings based on patient survival count

All of these core components were kept exactly as intended. The changes we made were primarily to improve clarity, reduce unnecessary mechanics and stay within scope.

2. Removal of Patient Time Limit

Pitch Expectation	We wanted to have a different time limit for each patient.
What Changed	We removed time limits completely from the game.
Why	We got feedback on the pitch and discovered that a time limit did not add a meaningful challenge. Players were already under enough pressure from dodging and managing incoming attacks.

3. Simplified infection

Pitch Expectation	We originally pitched multiple types of infection enemies with different behaviours.
What Changed	During development, we focused more on making the boss battles distinct and entertaining. As a result, the obstacle section with the mini infections was simplified. So instead of different behaviours, the mini infections only differ in appearance, not functionality.
Why	The boss battles are the strategic and central parts of the

	game, so they benefit most from unique mechanics and complexity. The obstacle section is designed to be a fast paced dodging challenge, so keeping those enemies simple made the gameplay clearer and avoided unnecessary confusion.
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4. Removal of shooting during Obstacle Gameplay

Pitch Expectation	The pitch included flying and shooting as core mechanics.
What Changed	In the obstacle section, the player cannot shoot. They can only dodge.
Why	Play testers (from Alpha Day) repeatedly questioned why they couldn't kill the obstacle enemies quickly, treating them like regular combat targets. This told us the shooting mechanic created false expectations and distracted from the intended experience in the obstacle part (i.e. a fast-paced, dodge-focused obstacle run).

5. Other mechanism we removed

Pitch Expectation	We discussed adding extra mechanics such as health boosts pills or white blood cells that could assist the player during the obstacle section or boss fights.
What Changed	These supportive mechanics were not implemented in the final game.
Why	Introducing helper systems added complexity to the design and would have required additional animations, behaviours, and UI elements. Given our timeline, we chose to prioritise polishing the core gameplay (i.e. dodging, shooting, and boss fights)